LUKAS MAHLER

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2025 -	**KU Leuven** Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
2024 - 2025	**KU Leuven** Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Economics

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATION

2025 -	**RFBerlin** Research Affiliate (ROCKWOOL Foundation Berlin)

EDUCATION

2018 - 2024	**University of Mannheim** Ph.D. in Economics
2016 - 2018	**University of Mannheim** Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Economics
2013 - 2016	**WHU - Otto Beisheim School of Management** Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in International Business Administration
Fall 2015	**University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign** Visiting Student

RESEARCH FIELDS

Macroeconomics, Labor Economics, Public Economics, Family Economics

RESEARCH

Working Papers

Early Decisions, Long-Lasting Consequences: The Macroeconomics of School Tracking [Link to Paper] (with Suzanne Bellue)

Published Papers

Policy Concerns in an Era of Low Fertility: The Role of Social Comparisons and Intensive Parenting [Link to Paper] (with Michèle Tertilt and Minchul Yum)
Brookings Papers on Economic Activity, Fall 2025

Lifestyle Behaviors and Wealth-Health Gaps in Germany [Link to Paper] (with Minchul Yum)
Econometrica, 2024

Aggregate and Distributional Effects of School Closure Mitigation Policies: Public versus Private Education [Link to Paper] (with Minchul Yum)
Economics Letters, 2024

Work in Progress

Health, Longevity, and Retirement Dynamics: Implications for Social Security Progressivity (with Minchul Yum)

REFERENCES

Prof. Antonio Ciccone, Ph.D.
University of Mannheim, Dept. of Economics
antonio.ciccone@uni-mannheim.de

Prof. Michèle Tertilt, Ph.D.
University of Mannheim, Dept. of Economics
michele.tertilt@uni-mannheim.de

Prof. Minchul Yum, Ph.D.
Virginia Commonwealth University, Dept. of Economics
yumm@vcu.edu

PRESENTATIONS

2026 (incl. scheduled): Ghent Empirical Macro Workshop, 1st Human Capital Conference Toulouse (co-author presenting), Bergen Macro Workshop, Univ. of Regensburg, DIW Berlin, Goethe Univ. Frankfurt

2025 : University of Birmingham, Tilburg University, Family Economics Workshop Bruges, Essen Health Conference, World Congress Econometric Society, UC Louvain

2024: ENSAE-CREST Paris, Household Economics PhD Workshop (ULB, ECARES)

2023 : Fed-St. Louis-JEDC-SCG-SNB-Conference (Gerzensee, Poster), Doctoral Workshop on Quantitative Dynamic Economics (Univ. of Strasbourg), EEA-ESEM Barcelona 2023, EUI ECO PhD Workshop, Workshop on Families, Human Capital, Inequality (Univ. of Mannheim, Univ. of Bonn, Poster), CRC Retreat, University of Mannheim Alumni Conference, EWMES 2023 Manchester

2022 : Vigo Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics, University of Mannheim, Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Workshop

2021 : University of Mannheim, Frankfurt-Mannheim Macro Workshop

TEACHING

Fall 2024 -	**Microeconomics (M.Sc.)** *KU Leuven*
Spring 2021 - 2024	**Economic Policy (B.Sc.)** Teaching Assistant, *University of Mannheim*
Fall 2020	**Advanced Macroeconomics (M.Sc.)** Teaching Assistant, *University of Mannheim*
Fall 2019	**Intermediate Macroeconomics (B.Sc.)** Teaching Assistant, *University of Mannheim*

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS

2025-2027	**KU Leuven** STG Grant (110,000 EUR)
2018 - 2020	**University of Mannheim** Scholarship for Ph.D. studies
2015	**German Academice Exchange Service (DAAD)** Scholarship for undergraduate studies at UIUC

SERVICES

Referee	Econometrica, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Human Capital
2025 - 2026	Organizer of the Economics Department Seminar Series at KU Leuven Co-organizer of the Leuven Economics Summer Event - Labor Economics

MISCELLANEOUS

Programming	Proficiency in Fortran, Matlab, Stata, R
Languages	German (native), English (fluent), Dutch (C1), French, Spanish (intermediate)
Citizenship	German

Updated October, 2026